

Interview Protocol for Professors at BYU

Purpose

To explore instructors' perspectives on the **linguistic skills** (listening, speaking, reading, writing) required for success in their courses at BYU, and to identify differences between students who succeed and those who struggle.

Format

- One-on-one interview (30–45 minutes).
- Responses will be anonymized (no names attached to quotes).
- Interviews will be audio-recorded with permission. Only researchers will have access to the recordings.

Interviewer Role

- Use questions as a guide, not a checklist.
 - Ask follow-up questions to clarify or probe for details. Help them talk about specific experiences they have had.
 - Keep the focus on *linguistic ability* (not general study skills, unless language and study skills overlap).
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Script

1. Introduction & Consent (3–5 min)

"Thank you for taking the time to meet. We're interested in understanding the language demands of your courses and what helps non-native English-speaking students succeed. Your input will remain confidential, and your name won't be linked to anything you say. We'll summarize findings across many instructors. The interview should take about 30–45 minutes."

- Confirm consent to proceed and record the interview.
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2. Warm-Up (5 min)

- "What experience do you have with non-native English-speaking students?"

3. Linguistic Demands of the Course (10–15 min)

- (Let them look over the survey and the tasks they marked for about two minutes.)
“Are the linguistic tasks you marked here on the survey accurate? Is there anything you would like to change?”
 - “What kinds of speaking, listening, reading, and writing tasks do non-native English-speaking students seem to struggle with the most? Can you think of specific experiences where students had difficulty with those tasks?”
 - “What do you think makes those tasks more difficult than others?”
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4. Characteristics of Successful Students (5–10 min)

- “What do your most successful non-native English-speaking students do well linguistically?”
 - “Are there particular strategies, habits, or skills that help them thrive?”
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5. Student Preparation (5–10 min)

- “Do you think first-year non-native English-speaking students are typically well-prepared for the linguistic demands of BYU? Why or why not?”
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6. Wrap-Up (3–5 min)

- “Is there anything we haven’t asked that you think is important to know?”
- “Are there any types of questions you think would be good to ask on the proficiency test?”

“Thank you for your time and insights. This information will help us better understand how to support international students at BYU. We will send you a copy of the transcript for your review. Please let us know if there are any answers you would like to change. If we don’t hear back from you, we will assume that everything is correct.”

Data Handling

- Code participants (e.g., Instructor 1, Instructor 2).
- Summarize themes across responses.
- Protect anonymity in reports.